Montrose Purple Vitex

Vitex agnus-castus 'Montrose Purple'

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available



Flower
Library candidate

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 10–25 ft (sources range from 8–12 ft to 20–25 ft). × 10–25 ft (sources range from 8–15 ft to 20–25 ft).
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Species is hardy in Zones 6–10 (sources vary 5–11). Performs well in Atlanta heat and humidity once established. Not stated for specific Atlanta microclimate notes.
Sun: Full sun.
Water: Low to moderate once established. Drought tolerant.
Soil: Well-drained. Adaptable to a range of soils. Prefers average fertility.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun and well-drained soil. Water regularly until established, then drought tolerant. Prune in late winter to shape or train to tree form by removing lower limbs. Benefits from occasional summer irrigation in extreme heat. Mulch to conserve moisture.
Soil prep: Well-drained. Adaptable to a range of soils. Prefers average fertility.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Species native to southern Europe and western Asia. Cultivar 'Montrose Purple' selected for large purple flower spikes. Selection history and introducer not stated by sources reviewed.
Form / habit: Deciduous multi-stemmed shrub or small tree. Upright to vase-shaped or rounded. Can be trained to tree form.
Foliage: Not significant.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Not stated in detail by sources.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: No serious problems stated by the majority of sources. Species is generally low-maintenance. Related cultivars noted as resistant to leaf spot. Occasional issues (leaf spot, minor insects) mentioned but not consistent across sources.
Not stated
Additional:
- Fragrant purple flower spikes in summer (June–August or longer). Attracts pollinators. - Aromatic gray-green palmate leaves. - Fast to moderate growth rate when young. - Can be grown as large shrub or trained as small tree.

Sources: - NC State Extension Gardener Plant Toolbox (Vitex agnus-castus) - Clemson HGIC Chastetree factsheet - UF/IFAS references on Vitex agnus-cas